

Gamage unpin

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We have already discussed in a previous article Goethart, a complex theme of unpin on the mating move. The essential features of Goethart are: a) interference of a pinned black piece by another black piece and b) a white battery piece unpins the pinned black piece taking advantage of the fact that the unpin does not release the defensive power previously nullified by self-interference.

Gamage is a simpler variety of unpin on the mating move where black piece is unpinned directly by the pinning white piece (after self-interference by black). Frederick Gamage (1881-1956) was a famous American problemist in the world of chess whose invention of black unpin by white became justly famous and named after him

H.E.Funk

Good Companions 1923(v)



Mate in two moves

The key 1.Rb4! (2.Rc3)

If black defends by playing 1...Bc5 white mates by 2.Qb5 which is Gamage unpin. The black bishop has interfered with newly pinned Rd5 preventing it from capturing Qb5. Similarly 1...Re5 2.Qh3 is yet another Gamage unpin because 2...Bg3 is ruled out by the black interference 1...Be5 2.Bb5; 1...Rc5 2.Nxc5 provide the by play. The half pin set up is an

unusual feature. Normally the unpinned piece on the mating move stays completely pinned in the initial position.

Udo Degener

3-4th HM, Troll 1977



Mate in two moves

1.Nb7?? (2.Rd6) 1...Bf4 2.Qg2 but 1...Be7!(Qb7?) Try 1.Ne4? 1...Be7 2.Qb7 but 1...Bf4!(2.Qg2?)

Key 1.Nb3! (2.Rd4) 1...Bf6 2.Qg2 1...Be7 2.Qa8. The theme embellished by logical tries. Gamage in a white pawn less setting.

A meredith (between seven and twelve pieces) Gamage for solving.

Csasz Karoli

Magyar Sakkelet 1977



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Selected Stocchi': Set: 1...b4 2.Qxa5(A) 1...Nd1 2.Qxa1(B)

Key 1.Qe1 waiting 1...b4 2.Qxa1(B); 1...Nd1 2.Qxa5 (A) Reciprocal change by separation of mates from set to key.

Readers may send in their queries to cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com